

GroomBook: one place for Kevin's booking requests

A focused MVP for taking requests, getting alerts and arranging appointments · Erik Ellis · October 3, 2026

Live app: groombook-eta.vercel.app **Dashboard:** </dashboard> · password **kevin-demo**

Code: github.com/ErikEllis-git/groombook

The problem and my first-release decision

"Clients text me to book, and I lose track of it all... I just want it to stop being chaotic."

Kevin needs one reliable place to see what has come in and decide what happens next. I scoped the first release to exactly his three asks. Customers *request* a day and time window; Kevin reviews the address and dog before setting a time, because a mobile groomer's day depends on drive time, coat condition and temperament.

Working assumptions (to confirm with Kevin): he's the only user, works from his phone, and wants to keep texting customers himself. His service area, hours and pricing are still open questions.

"People can request an appointment"

A booking page

A short, phone-friendly form for contact details, address, dog, size, service and preferences. Customers are told it's a request, not a reserved slot.

"See all the requests in one place"

One dashboard

New requests oldest first. Kevin confirms a time, declines or completes a job, with Call, Text and Maps one tap away. Upcoming jobs are grouped by day.

"Get notified when a new one comes in"

Phone alerts

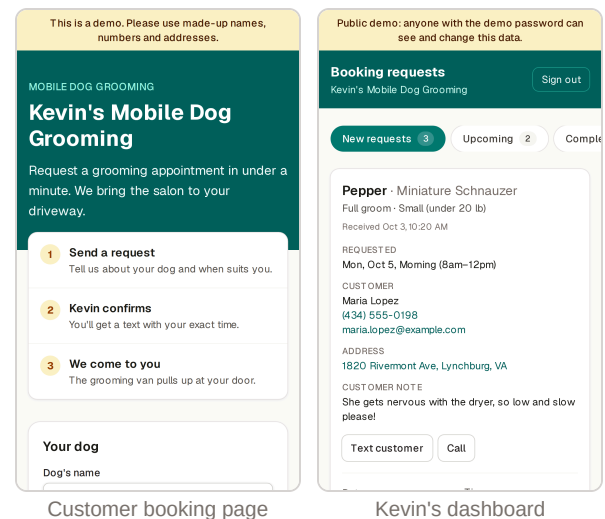
A push alert summarizes each request and opens the dashboard. Contact details stay out of the alert, and requests stay saved even if an alert fails.

How Kevin uses it

1. Share the booking link; reply to booking texts with it.
2. A new request buzzes his phone. He checks travel, timing and price.
3. Set a time and tap **Confirm**.
4. **Text confirmation** opens his messages with the reply written; he sends it and ticks **Mark text sent**.
5. After the groom: **Mark completed**.

Before rollout: validate with Kevin

- Where does the chaos happen: missed requests, slow replies or double-booking?
- His service area, travel buffers, current calendar and payment tools, and budget.
- **Two-week pilot:** send booking texts to the link, then compare unanswered requests and admin time. Old texts aren't imported, so we'd reconcile existing bookings once.



Customer booking page

Kevin's dashboard

Build vs. buy, and next steps

Off-the-shelf tools already cover parts of this: Square Appointments (free plan) can require Kevin to accept each request, and MoeGo (\$49/mo) adds reminders and mobile scheduling. Before a real rollout I'd compare them with Kevin against his workflow and budget; GroomBook shows the focused flow and is ready to pilot. Likely next steps, if the pilot supports them: pet history and easy rebooking, then reminders. The demo runs on free tiers; real commercial use needs a paid hosting plan (~\$20/mo) and a support plan.